**WRENFORD BOROUGH COUNCIL**

# Past Report Decisions Casebook

Document Casebook 01 | Issue 2 | Owner: Street Care Office | Review cycle: every six months

## 1. About this casebook

Eight past reviews, kept as worked examples of the Highways Policy, the Report Rules and the defect standards in practice. Each case records the report, its answers as they were written, each requirement's result, the coordination triggers, the decisions open, the decision taken and why, and how the repair went.

The casebook is background reading for Street Care Coordinators and Highways Inspectors. It is never cited to a reporter as a rule, and a report is always reviewed under the latest issue of its own defect type's standard, whatever an earlier case decided.

## 2. A carriageway report read against the footway standard

Report SC0050214, sent from the website, reported a pothole in the road outside a row of shops on Sheep Street. It was reviewed under the carriageway standard.

The report gave: defect type "Carriageway"; linked defect type "No linked defect"; street category "Local road"; location fixed "Yes"; photograph "Yes"; depth "32"; width "350".

The coordinator who opened the review first read the footway standard, whose sentences are almost the same, and found the depth within it. Read against the carriageway standard, the report's own, 32 millimetres is short of the figure, so the depth requirement was not met. Nothing was live on the street, and a local road is not traffic sensitive.

- **Location fixed**, carriageway standard - Met
- **Photograph**, carriageway standard - Met
- **Depth**, carriageway standard - Not met
- **Width**, carriageway standard - Met

The assessment was INSPECT ON SITE. No coordination trigger applied. The decisions open were INSPECT ON SITE and REFER FOR COORDINATION.

The Highways Inspector sent it for inspection on site. The inspector measured the pothole at 35 millimetres, recorded it for the next routine inspection and closed the report.

## 3. A caller's inches

Report SC0050377, sent from the contact centre as 50377, reported a raised paving slab on the way to the shops on Elm Terrace. It was reviewed under the footway standard.

The report gave: defect type "FW"; linked defect type "NIL"; street category "LR"; location fixed "Y"; photograph "Y"; depth "1 in"; width "14 in".

The contact centre writes the caller's inches: 1 in is 25 mm and 14 in is 356 mm, both within the footway standard's figures, and the caller had emailed a photograph. Read as millimetres, the same figures would have failed both requirements and sent a sound report for inspection. Nothing was live on the street.

- **Location fixed**, footway standard - Met
- **Photograph**, footway standard - Met
- **Depth**, footway standard - Met
- **Width**, footway standard - Met

The assessment was ORDER REPAIR. No coordination trigger applied. The decisions open were ORDER REPAIR, INSPECT ON SITE and REFER FOR COORDINATION.

The Highways Inspector ordered the repair, and the works order gave both measurements in millimetres. The slab was relaid on the first visit.

## 4. Street works live in the same part of the highway

Report SC0050452, sent from the StreetCare app as SC-50452, reported a pothole beside a utility trench on Kingsley Road. It was reviewed under the carriageway standard.

The report gave: defect type "Pothole or road surface"; linked defect type "None"; street category "Residential street"; location fixed "true"; photograph "true"; depth "5.5 cm"; width "40 cm".

Every requirement was met: 5.5 cm is 55 mm and 40 cm is 400 mm. But the street works register showed two permits live on the street: a fibre installation in the footway, which conflicts with nothing in the road, and a water main repair in the carriageway, which does. The pothole lay at the edge of the water company's trench, so the live street works trigger applied.

- **Location fixed**, carriageway standard - Met
- **Photograph**, carriageway standard - Met
- **Depth**, carriageway standard - Met
- **Width**, carriageway standard - Met

The assessment was REFER FOR COORDINATION. The coordination triggers that applied: live street works. The decisions open were INSPECT ON SITE and REFER FOR COORDINATION.

The Highways Inspector referred it for coordination. The network coordination team agreed with the water company that the pothole would be made good in its own permanent reinstatement.

### 5. A cancelled permit does not count

Report SC0050518, sent from the website, reported standing water across the lane by a blocked gully on Brook Lane. It was reviewed under the drainage standard.

The report gave: defect type "Drainage"; linked defect type "No linked defect"; street category "Local road"; location fixed "Yes"; photograph "Yes"; water depth "65"; water location "Carriageway"; reach "1.4".

The street works register showed a water company permit for a leak repair in Brook Lane's carriageway, which would conflict with a drainage defect. But that permit had been cancelled and its works would not take place, so it did not count, and no coordination trigger applied. The water stood 65 millimetres deep and reached 1.4 metres from the kerb, so every requirement was met.

- **Location fixed**, drainage standard - Met
- **Photograph**, drainage standard - Met
- **Water depth**, drainage standard - Met
- **Water reach**, drainage standard - Met

The assessment was ORDER REPAIR. No coordination trigger applied. The decisions open were ORDER REPAIR, INSPECT ON SITE and REFER FOR COORDINATION.

The Highways Inspector ordered the repair, and the gully was cleansed on the first visit.

### 6. A linked defect must meet both standards

Report SC0050663, sent from the website, reported a street light out under an overgrown tree on Cedar Way. It was reviewed under the street lighting standard and, for its linked defect type, the vegetation standard.

The report gave: defect type "Street lighting"; linked defect type "Vegetation"; street category "Local road"; location fixed "Yes"; fault "Lamp out"; column number "Yes"; column height "6"; overhang "Footway"; clear height "2.4"; highway land "Yes".

Every requirement of the street lighting standard was met, the lamp out on a 6 metre column with its column number given. The branches made vegetation its linked defect type, and a report must meet its linked type's standard as well as its own: a clear height of exactly 2.4 metres over the footway is not less than the vegetation standard's figure, so the clear height was not met.

- **Location fixed**, street lighting standard - Met
- **Column number**, street lighting standard - Met
- **Column lean**, street lighting standard - Met
- **Location fixed**, vegetation standard - Met
- **Highway land**, vegetation standard - Met
- **Clear height**, vegetation standard - Not met

The assessment was INSPECT ON SITE. No coordination trigger applied. The decisions open were INSPECT ON SITE and REFER FOR COORDINATION.

The Highways Inspector sent it for inspection on site. The inspector found the branches lower by the lamp head and ordered the cut back with the lamp replacement.

### 7. Drainage on a traffic-sensitive street

Report SC0050729, sent from the StreetCare app as SC-50729, reported standing water across the bus lane on London Road. It was reviewed under the drainage standard.

The report gave: defect type "Flooding or blocked drain"; linked defect type "None"; street category "Main route"; location fixed "true"; photograph "true"; water depth "7 cm"; water location "Road"; reach "1.5 m".

Every requirement was met: 7 cm is 70 mm, and the water reached 1.5 metres from the kerb. London Road is a traffic-sensitive street, and a drainage repair there needs road space and traffic management, so the traffic-sensitive street trigger applied. Nothing was live on the street.

- **Location fixed**, drainage standard - Met
- **Photograph**, drainage standard - Met
- **Water depth**, drainage standard - Met
- **Water reach**, drainage standard - Met

The assessment was REFER FOR COORDINATION. The coordination triggers that applied: traffic-sensitive street. The decisions open were INSPECT ON SITE and REFER FOR COORDINATION.

The Highways Inspector referred it for coordination. The network coordination team booked a lane closure with the bus operator, and the gully was cleansed.

### 8. A column height in feet

Report SC0050841, sent from the contact centre as 50841, reported a street light out by a bus stop on Victoria Road. It was reviewed under the street lighting standard.

The report gave: defect type "SL"; linked defect type "NIL"; street category "TS"; location fixed "Y"; fault "OUT"; column number "Y"; column height "39 ft".

The contact centre's inventory screen gives the column height in feet: 39 ft is 11.9 metres, taller than 8, so the high column trigger applied. Every requirement was met, the lamp out with its column number given. A street light is not a carriageway or drainage defect, so the traffic-sensitive street trigger did not apply.

- **Location fixed**, street lighting standard - Met
- **Column number**, street lighting standard - Met
- **Column lean**, street lighting standard - Met

The assessment was REFER FOR COORDINATION. The coordination triggers that applied: high column. The decisions open were INSPECT ON SITE and REFER FOR COORDINATION.

The Highways Inspector referred it for coordination. The network coordination team booked the high-reach platform and a lane closure, and the lamp was replaced.

### 9. A description that disagreed with the report

Report SC0050906, sent from the website, reported a sunken slab outside a newsagent on Albert Street. It was reviewed under the footway standard.

The report gave: defect type "Footway"; linked defect type "No linked defect"; street category "Local road"; location fixed "Yes"; photograph "Yes"; depth "25"; width "400".

The resident description said: "It is about 15 mm deep."

Every requirement was met, and nothing was live on the street. But the resident description said that the slab was about 15 millimetres deep where the report said 25, and the sentence was flagged DISAGREES WITH FORM.

- **Location fixed**, footway standard - Met
- **Photograph**, footway standard - Met
- **Depth**, footway standard - Met
- **Width**, footway standard - Met

The assessment was ORDER REPAIR. No coordination trigger applied. The decisions open were ORDER REPAIR, INSPECT ON SITE and REFER FOR COORDINATION.

The Highways Inspector sent it for inspection on site to settle the depth, which INSPECT ON SITE, always open, allows. The inspector measured 26 millimetres, and the slab was relaid.